

FIRST-PASS QUALITY AI SOFTWARE WORKFLOW

The reusable process for getting the strongest possible first result, then refining only what is actually weak until it is ready to ship.

CORE RULE: KEEP THE PROMPT SHORT. PUT TASTE + TOOLS UNDERNEATH IT. GIVE CREATIVE FREEDOM. REQUIRE THE AGENT TO LOOK AT ITS OWN RESULT BEFORE HANDOFF.

00

SET UP ONCE

Verified starter, browser/screenshots, media generation, UI primitives, build/test/deploy path, and a compact taste pack.

01

SHORT OUTCOME PROMPT

State the user, job, primary action, hard truths, quality bar, mode, and what the agent may invent. Nothing else unless needed.

02

ONE STRONG DIRECTION

Let the agent co-invent identity, copy, composition, meaningful signature asset, typography, and motion over a professional craft floor.

03

EARLY REAL RENDER

Before finishing everything, render hero/core workspace + one deeper section/state + mobile. The agent reviews this itself.

04

REPAIR OR PIVOT

Keep what works. Choose local repair, refine, pivot one element, or pivot the whole premise only when the core is wrong.

05

COMPLETE + SELF-REFINE

Finish the experience, capture it, fix the 2-3 biggest problems, render again, and repeat without waiting for another user prompt.

06

FREEZE + SCALE

When the direction is genuinely strong, extract its design system. Then build real software vertically with real behavior and states.

07

ATTACK + RELEASE

Run visual, UX, accessibility, performance, reliability/security, architecture/code, staging, and fresh release review.

08

LEARN

Only recurring accepted corrections become reusable taste notes, primitives, checks, tests, or baselines.

FIRST-HANDOFF TARGET: A COHERENT, DISTINCT, PRODUCT-SPECIFIC 7-8+ SEED. REFINEMENT SHOULD DEVELOP QUALITY, NOT RESCUE GARBAGE.

SET UP ONCE

Make every future prompt cheap and powerful.

The sophisticated part lives in the environment. The user prompt carries only the mission.

PERMANENT ASSET	MINIMUM CONTENTS	PURPOSE
Verified starter	Routing, responsive shell, fonts, accessible controls, build/test/deploy.	Removes infrastructure waste and avoidable bugs.
Craft substrate	Semantic tokens/ramps, primitives, states, focus/touch behavior, common higher-order blocks.	Prevents random craft without pre-deciding the brand.
Taste pack	1-2 accepted internal benchmarks, 2-3 annotated external examples, rejected examples, before/after corrections.	Defines what "good" means to us without a giant prompt.
Reality tools	Browser/computer, screenshots, console/network, repo/shell, image/media generation, tests.	Lets the agent inspect and verify its own work.

Taste pack rules

- Annotate why each example is good: composition, hierarchy, typography, motion, product presentation, copy, or conversion - not just "I like it."
- Keep brand-specific choices local. Do not turn VEIL-style pills, colors, or motion into universal laws.
- Use images first. A few annotated screenshots usually communicate more than pages of design prose.
- Keep the starter visually neutral. It should encode professional craft, not the next brand identity.

DEFAULT TASTE PACK: 1-2 ACCEPTED INTERNAL EXAMPLES + 2-3 EXTERNAL REFERENCES MAX. ADD MORE ONLY TO SOLVE A LIVE PROBLEM.

Minimal reusable structure

REPOSITORY
/ai-os AGENTS.md - short permanent contract /taste - PROFILE.md + accepted/rejected/before-after screenshots /ui - tokens + primitives + reusable blocks /qa - captures + visual baselines /starter - verified site/app foundation

THE ONLY STARTING PROMPT

One compact prompt should launch the whole creative run.

Do not paste this PDF into the task. Load the taste pack and project truth from the repo.

MASTER PROJECT PROMPT

Build a complete **[CONCEPT / INTERACTIVE PROTOTYPE / PRODUCTION]** **[landing page / application]** for **[AUDIENCE + PRODUCT]**.

Primary job/outcome: **[WHAT THE USER MUST UNDERSTAND OR COMPLETE]**.

Primary action: **[CTA / TASK]**.

Hard truths/constraints: **[PRODUCT FACTS, REQUIRED CONTENT, TECH/DOMAIN LIMITS]**.

Use the attached taste profile and approved examples as the quality benchmark. Match their level of craft without copying their identity. You own the brand/art direction, composition, meaningful product visuals, copy, typography, and motion unless an accepted project system already exists. Make strong decisions.

First render an early sample: the hero/core workspace, one representative deeper section/state, and mobile. Judge it against the product job and the taste pack. Fix only what is weak; pivot the smallest thing that is conceptually wrong. Once the direction is strong, complete the experience.

Run your own screenshot/use/review/fix passes. Preserve strong decisions and snapshots. Do not wait for me to manage the phases. Before handoff, verify the requirements appropriate to the stated mode and clearly identify anything still unverified.

What belongs in the first prompt

MUST CONTAIN	USUALLY EXCLUDE
User/audience + outcome + primary action	A long design manifesto
Mode: concept / prototype / production	Dozens of arbitrary visual numbers
Hard product/domain/technical truth	Every research source at once
Taste pack / approved examples	Every possible edge case
Authority: what the agent may invent	Micromanagement of implementation details
Handoff expectations	Conflicting duplicate rules from old docs

OPTIMIZE FOR INFORMATION DENSITY, NOT WORD COUNT. SHORT IS GOOD ONLY IF THE RIGHT INFORMATION IS ALREADY AVAILABLE.

FIRST-PASS ENGINE

How the agent should use that one prompt.

The first result should already contain a real idea. The agent must inspect it before you see it.

01

UNDERSTAND THE PRODUCT

Lock the user, job, value, primary action, content truth, and constraints before styling.

02

FORM ONE COHERENT DIRECTION

Co-invent brand identity, visual metaphor, type, palette, composition, copy voice, section rhythm, and motion concept together.

03

AUTHOR THE SIGNATURE ASSET EARLY

If a hero/product visual carries quality, generate/source several serious directions and select the one that best explains the product and fits the composition.

04

BUILD THE EARLY SAMPLE

Hero/core workspace + one representative deeper section/state + mobile. Use realistic copy/data, not empty placeholders.

05

LOOK AT IT

Open the actual render. Check concept, originality, hierarchy, readability, product clarity, asset meaning, conversion/UX, and obvious technical problems.

06

CHOOSE THE SMALLEST CORRECT ACTION

LOCAL REPAIR, REFINE, PIVOT ELEMENT, or PIVOT DIRECTION.

07

COMPLETE THE EXPERIENCE

Only after the seed is worth developing. Then finish the page/product using the proven identity.

08

SELF-REFINE BEFORE HANDOFF

Capture desktop/mobile, fix 2-3 highest-impact problems per pass, render/use again, preserve snapshots, stop when major issues are gone or improvement plateaus.

DO NOT GENERATE THREE FULL DESIGNS BY DEFAULT. IF THE FIRST DIRECTION HAS REAL POTENTIAL, DEVELOP IT. BRANCH ONLY WHEN THE PREMISE IS GENERIC OR WRONG.

DIRECTION GATE + REFINEMENT

Keep good work. Replace only the thing that failed.

DECISION	USE WHEN	ACTION
LOCAL REPAIR	One component, copy block, state, spacing, or control is weak.	Fix that part. Preserve the rest.
REFINE	The core identity/concept is strong but underdeveloped.	Increase clarity, depth, hierarchy, motion, copy, and craft.
PIVOT ELEMENT	A major part such as hero, pricing, product demo, footer, or asset is conceptually wrong.	Replace that element while protecting the successful identity.
PIVOT DIRECTION	The core premise is generic, wrong for the product, or has no recognizable identity.	Branch from the last useful snapshot and create a new premise.

Evaluator evidence - no vague criticism

- Name the viewport and exact section/component.
- Describe the visible problem, not the hoped-for feeling.
- Explain why it hurts hierarchy, meaning, conversion, UX, or craft.
- Propose the smallest fix that preserves successful decisions.
- After the fix, render again and verify that the specific problem improved without regressions.

First-handoff minimum bar

AREA	V1 MUST ALREADY SHOW
Identity	Distinct, coherent visual direction - not generic SaaS/template output.
Hero / core workspace	Strong composition and a meaningful product-specific concept.
Typography	Readable hierarchy, good contrast, deliberate scale and wrapping.
Copy / product clarity	User can understand what it does, why it matters, and what to do next.
Composition	Clear rhythm, whitespace, focal points, section pacing; no box soup.
Assets	At least one serious bespoke/product-specific visual where the concept benefits from it.
Interaction / motion	Enough continuity and feedback to feel alive; no decorative chaos.
Mobile	Intentionally composed, not shrink-to-fit.
Technical health	No obvious broken controls, runtime errors, unreadable states, or severe layout failures.

IF THE FIRST HANDOFF MISSES THIS BAR, THE AGENT SHOULD KEEP WORKING BEFORE IT CALLS THE TASK DONE.

FREEZE, BUILD, RELEASE

Once the design earns it, creativity narrows and engineering evidence takes over.

Do not formalize an early mistake. Freeze only when remaining critique is refinement, not “different idea.”

1. Freeze the successful direction

- Capture approved desktop/mobile screens and important states.
- Extract values/principles, semantic tokens/ramps, canonical primitives, higher-order blocks, typography, assets, motion/interaction grammar, responsive rules, copy hierarchy, and anti-patterns.
- After freeze, visual/behavior drift is a defect unless a concrete product/usability/engineering reason justifies change.

2. Match verification to the mode

MODE	MUST BE REAL BEFORE HANDOFF
DESIGN CONCEPT	Visual hierarchy, responsive composition, interaction intent, honest labeling. Backend/auth/persistence can be omitted.
INTERACTIVE PROTOTYPE	Primary front-end flow, demo states, keyboard/touch basics, believable data. Production backend may be mocked if clearly labeled.
PRODUCTION	Real state/data path, persistence, auth/permissions where relevant, failures, accessibility, performance, reliability/security, monitoring/deployment.

3. For production software: prove one golden user job, then scale vertically

01

IMPLEMENT

One real user-facing capability with canonical UI, real state/data shape, and the real mutation/response path.

02

USE

Click/type/keyboard/touch through it. Include success, loading, error, permission, and destructive states where relevant.

03

RENDER + COMPARE

Desktop/mobile against approved references. Check hierarchy, wrapping, density, assets, states, and interaction continuity.

04

REPAIR

Fix the highest-impact perceptual, UX, functional, or architectural defect first.

05

ACCEPT + SCALE

Only then extend the next vertical capability.

4. Release attack

- Visual/responsive: native-size captures, typography/wrapping, assets/crops, motion, mobile re-authoring, no post-freeze drift.
- UX: happy path + loading/empty/error/success/disabled/permission/destructive; deep links; refresh/back; slow/offline when relevant.
- Accessibility: semantics, labels, keyboard/focus, contrast, touch targets, reduced motion, critical screen-reader path.
- Performance: profile bundle/network/media/render/memory, set budgets, rerun after fixes.
- Security/reliability: trust boundaries, validation, object permissions, secrets, dependencies, observability, rollback.
- Code/architecture: no accidental complexity, dead/duplicate logic, fragile effects, or abstractions with no value.
- Fresh release review: separate reviewer/context sees the running result and decides SHIP or DO NOT SHIP.

REUSE ONLY WHAT EARNS IT: RECURRING ACCEPTED TASTE -> TASTE PACK. REPEATED MECHANIC -> TOKEN/COMPONENT/BLOCK. DETECTABLE FAILURE -> CHECK/TEST. ONE-OFF OPINION -> NOTHING YET.